‘But surely you cannot have any objection to goat’s milk then,’ she interposed.

The doctor too took up the strain. ‘If you will take goat’s milk, it will be enough for me,’ he said.

I succumbed. My intense eagerness to take up the Satyagraha fight had created in me a strong desire to live, and so I contented myself with adhering to the letter of my vow only, and sacrificed the spirit. For although I had only the milk of the cow and the she-buffalo in mind when I took the vow, by natural implication it covered the milk of all animals. Nor could it be right for me to use milk at all, so long as I held that milk is not the natural diet of man. Yet knowing all this I agreed to take goat’s milk. The will to live proved stronger than the devotion to truth, and for once the votary of truth compromised his sacred ideal by his eagerness to take up the Satyagraha fight. The memory of this action even now rankles in my breast and fills me with remorse, and I am constantly thinking how to give up goat’s milk. But I cannot yet free myself from that subtlest of temptations, the desire to serve, which still holds me.

My experiments in dietetics are dear to me as a part of my researches in *Ahimsa*. They give me recreation and joy. But my use of goat’s milk today troubles me not from the view-point of dietetic *Ahimsa* so much as from that of truth, being no less than a breach of pledge. It seems to me that I understand the ideal of truth better than that of *Ahimsa*, and my experience tells me that, if I let go my hold of truth, I shall never be able to solve the riddle of *Ahimsa*. The ideal of truth requires that vows taken